PLATFORM & SYSTEMS INTEGRATION REFERENCE

dtdm.us Project Reference Document

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19 categories · 150+ platforms mapped across payments, marketing, CRM, commerce, community, automation, and AI infrastructure.

About This Document

This reference document maps the full ecosystem of platforms, tools, and systems that clients, prospects, and partners may be using — or that would be relevant to recommend when building digital products, marketing systems, automations, and sales infrastructure.

Use this file when:

- Scoping a new project to understand what tools to integrate with
- Evaluating what a client's existing stack implies about their sophistication
- Recommending the right tool for a specific function
- Writing sales copy or product pages that reference integrations
- Designing automation workflows and needing to know what connects to what

TIER KEY Free · Free/Paid · Paid · One-time · Enterprise · Usage *(per-transaction/use)*

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SECTION 01 / 19

Payment Processing

How customers pay. Choice of processor affects fee structure, supported countries, payout speed, and checkout UX. Most platforms have a preferred processor — always verify compatibility before recommending.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Stripe	Full-stack payments: cards, ACH, wallets, subscriptions, invoicing	SaaS, digital products, e-commerce, subscriptions	USAGE	*Industry default. Best docs. 2.9%+30¢ per transaction. Excellent for recurring billing.*
PayU	Payment gateway strong in Eastern Europe, India, Latin America	International businesses in emerging markets	USAGE	*Strong where Stripe is unavailable. Multiple local payment methods.*
Braintree	Payments subsidiary of PayPal — cards, PayPal, Venmo, wallets	Mid-market, marketplace, US-heavy	USAGE	*Owned by PayPal. Good for businesses needing PayPal+card in one SDK.*
Checkout.com	Enterprise payment processing with global acquiring	High-volume, enterprise, global expansion	PAID	*Lower rates at scale. Strong in UK/EU. Enterprise-first.*
Square	POS + online payments + invoicing	In-person retail, hybrid brick+digital	FREE/PAID	*Great for physical locations. Ecosystem lock-in with hardware.*
Authorize.net	Legacy payment gateway, widely supported by banks	Established businesses, bank-preferred setups	PAID	*Older platform but trusted by banks and older enterprise clients.*
GoCardless	Bank-to-bank direct debit, recurring payments	SaaS, memberships, UK/EU businesses	USAGE	*Low fees for recurring. No card network dependency. Strong in EU.*
Chargebee	Subscription billing management and revenue ops	SaaS with complex billing logic	PAID	*Sits on top of Stripe/Braintree. Handles dunning, trials, upgrades.*
Recurly	Subscription management and billing platform	Mid-market SaaS, media, subscription boxes	PAID	*Competitor to Chargebee. Good churn recovery tools.*
Zettle (PayPal)	Mobile POS for in-person card acceptance	Pop-ups, markets, small retail	FREE/PAID	*Hardware-based. Connects to PayPal ecosystem.*
ThriveCart	Checkout pages, upsells, affiliates, lifetime license	Digital product sellers, course creators	ONE-TIME	*$495–595 one-time. No monthly fee. Strong affiliate management.*

SECTION 02 / 19

Email & Marketing Automation

The engine behind nurture sequences, broadcasts, and lifecycle marketing. Platform choice determines deliverability, automation depth, list segmentation, and tagging logic. Many digital product businesses run their entire backend on one of these.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Mailchimp	Email marketing, basic automations, audience management	Small businesses, beginners, side projects	FREE/PAID	*Most recognized brand. Clean interface but automation logic is limited vs. competitors.*
ActiveCampaign	Advanced email automation, CRM, lead scoring, site tracking	Serious digital marketers, course sellers, agencies	PAID	*Gold standard for automation depth. CRM built in. $29/mo starting.*
Klaviyo	Email + SMS, deep e-commerce data integration	E-commerce, Shopify brands, product businesses	FREE/PAID	*Dominant in e-commerce email. Pulls product/order data natively.*
ConvertKit	Creator-focused email, simple automations, landing pages	Creators, newsletters, bloggers, solopreneurs	FREE/PAID	*Clean UX. Strong subscriber tagging. Now called Kit.*
MailerLite	Email + automations + landing pages + forms	Small-medium businesses, cost-conscious operators	FREE/PAID	*Free to 1k subscribers. Strong value. Good for TRACTION-type builds.*
HubSpot Email	Email within HubSpot CRM suite	B2B, sales-led companies, agencies	FREE/PAID	*Most powerful when used with HubSpot CRM. Overkill if email-only.*
Drip	E-commerce email automation with behavioral triggers	E-commerce, D2C brands	PAID	*Similar to Klaviyo. Shopify/WooCommerce native.*
Constant Contact	Email marketing, event management, social tools	Nonprofits, local businesses, events	PAID	*Legacy platform. Strong event/RSVP tools. Not ideal for automation-heavy builds.*
Beehiiv	Newsletter platform with monetization features	Newsletter businesses, media, creator economy	FREE/PAID	*Built by Morning Brew team. Paid subscriptions + ad network built in.*
Substack	Newsletter + paid subscription publishing	Writers, journalists, solo creators	FREE/PAID	*Takes % of paid subscriptions. Built-in audience discovery.*
Brevo (Sendinblue)	Email, SMS, WhatsApp, transactional and marketing	European businesses, multi-channel needs	FREE/PAID	*Strong transactional email. GDPR-friendly. Free plan is generous.*

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CRM & Lead Management

Tracks contacts, deals, and pipelines. CRM selection signals the sales motion — high-volume outbound, inbound-led, or relationship-based. Many businesses use a CRM plus a separate email platform.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
HubSpot	Full CRM suite — contacts, deals, sequences, reporting	Inbound-led B2B, agencies, growing teams	FREE/PAID	*Free CRM is genuinely good. Expensive at scale. Most common in mid-market B2B.*
Salesforce	Enterprise CRM, deep customization, massive ecosystem	Enterprise, large sales teams, complex orgs	PAID	*Industry standard at enterprise level. Requires admin/implementation. High cost.*
Pipedrive	Visual pipeline CRM, deal-focused	SMB sales teams, deal-heavy sales motions	PAID	*Clean interface. Very visual. Strong for product/service sales pipelines.*
Zoho CRM	Full CRM with AI features, strong Zoho ecosystem integration	SMBs wanting all-in-one Zoho stack	FREE/PAID	*Best value if already using Zoho products. Less intuitive than HubSpot.*
Close CRM	Built-in calling, email, SMS, pipeline management	Inside sales teams, high-activity outbound	PAID	*Communication-first CRM. Calling built in. Popular with outbound-heavy teams.*
GoHighLevel	CRM + funnels + email + SMS + calendar + pipeline	Agencies, local service businesses	PAID	*$97–297/mo. White-label ready. Replaces 6–8 tools. Agency favorite.*
Gymsales	Gym/fitness-specific CRM with lead management	Gyms, fitness studios	PAID	*Niche vertical CRM. Seen in gym platform integrations.*
Gymleads	Lead capture and follow-up CRM for fitness businesses	Gyms, personal trainers, fitness centers	PAID	*Simpler than Gymsales. Focused on lead conversion pipeline.*
Referrizer	Referral and loyalty automation for local businesses	Gyms, salons, local service businesses	PAID	*Automates referral asks and reward delivery. Common in fitness vertical.*
Ripple	Fitness-specific sales management system	Gyms, fitness studios	PAID	*Niche system seen in gym stack integrations.*
Attio	Modern relational CRM, data-flexible	Startups, VC-backed teams, modern B2B	FREE/PAID	*Growing fast. Notion-like flexibility. Strong API.*

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Scheduling & Booking

Appointment booking, class scheduling, and calendar management. Fitness and service businesses often use vertical-specific tools (Mindbody, Glofox) over generic options. Instagram “Book Now” connects to ~46 of these platforms.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Mindbody	Class scheduling, memberships, POS for wellness/fitness	Gyms, yoga studios, wellness centers	PAID	*Dominant in fitness vertical. Expensive but deeply integrated in the space.*
Acuity Scheduling	Appointment booking, intake forms, payment collection	Solo practitioners, coaches, consultants	PAID	*Owned by Squarespace. Clean UX. Strong for 1-on-1 booking.*
Vagaro	Booking, POS, memberships for beauty/fitness/wellness	Salons, spas, fitness studios	PAID	*Common in beauty vertical. Lower cost than Mindbody.*
Glofox	Gym/studio management — booking, billing, reporting	Boutique fitness studios, CrossFit boxes	PAID	*Fitness-specific. Strong mobile app for members.*
Calendly	Simple appointment scheduling, calendar sync	Sales calls, consulting, interviews	FREE/PAID	*Most recognized scheduling tool. Simple but limited for complex scenarios.*
Cal.com	Open-source scheduling, highly customizable	Developers, privacy-conscious businesses	FREE/PAID	*Calendly alternative. Self-hostable. Growing fast.*
Setmore	Appointment booking with team and class features	Small service businesses	FREE/PAID	*Free tier is generous. Connects to Instagram Book Now.*
SimplyBook.me	Feature-rich booking for service businesses	Complex service businesses, international	FREE/PAID	*Highly customizable. Strong feature set for price. Common in spa/salon.*
Booksy	Marketplace + booking for beauty/barber professionals	Barbers, hairdressers, beauty professionals	PAID	*Has built-in marketplace discovery. Popular in beauty vertical.*
GlossGenius	All-in-one for beauty and wellness professionals	Independent beauty professionals	PAID	*Clean design focus. Cards, booking, client management.*
ABC Fitness	Club management software for larger fitness operations	Multi-location gyms, health clubs	PAID	*Enterprise-leaning. Billing, access control, reporting.*
Zen Planner	Gym/martial arts studio management	CrossFit, martial arts, functional fitness	PAID	*Strong in boutique gym and martial arts segment.*
ClubReady	Franchise gym management software	Franchise fitness brands	PAID	*Built for franchise operations with multi-location controls.*

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Fitness, Wellness & Health Apps

Wearables, tracking apps, and wellness platforms. Relevant for integration when building health-adjacent products, apps, or services that benefit from user health data or workout history.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Wellhub (Gympass)	Corporate wellness benefit connecting employees to gyms/apps	Gyms seeking corporate clients	PAID	*Formerly Gympass. Major source of gym memberships via employer benefit.*
ClassPass	Fitness class marketplace/subscription	Boutique studios wanting discovery + new members	PAID	*Drives studio discovery and fills off-peak slots.*
Apple Health	Central health data store on iOS	Any fitness/health app on iPhone	FREE	*HealthKit API. Permission-based data access. Highly trusted by users.*
Google Fit	Android health data platform	Android fitness apps	FREE	*Less dominant than Apple Health. Activity and vitals data.*
MyFitnessPal	Nutrition tracking and calorie counting	Nutrition-adjacent apps and services	FREE/PAID	*Largest nutrition database. API available. Common in diet/coaching apps.*
Strava	Activity tracking for running, cycling, endurance sports	Running/cycling communities and coaching apps	FREE/PAID	*Social layer for athletes. Strong API for activity data.*
Whoop	Recovery and strain tracking wearable	Performance-focused athletes, high-performers	PAID	*Subscription hardware model. Data-rich API. High engagement users.*
Garmin Connect	Fitness data from Garmin wearables	Endurance athletes, outdoors, military	FREE	*Deep sensor data. API for developers. Strong in running/triathlon.*
Fitbit / Google	Consumer fitness tracking wearables	General fitness consumers	FREE/PAID	*Now under Google. Large installed base. API access available.*
Oura Ring	Sleep and recovery tracking ring	Sleep-focused, biohackers, executives	PAID	*Subscription hardware. Sleep data is best-in-class. Growing fast.*

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Analytics & Reporting

Turning data into decisions. Analytics stack choice depends on whether the need is website behavior, product usage, business intelligence, or all three. Most businesses underinvest here until they need it urgently.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Google Analytics 4	Website and app behavior analytics	Any web property	FREE	*Industry standard. Replaced Universal Analytics. Event-based model.*
Looker (Google)	Business intelligence and data visualization	Data teams, enterprise BI	PAID	*Seen in gym platform stack. Google-owned. SQL-based data exploration.*
Tableau	Data visualization and BI dashboards	Enterprise analytics, data-heavy orgs	PAID	*Industry leader in data viz. Salesforce-owned. High cost but powerful.*
Mixpanel	Product analytics — user behavior, funnels, retention	SaaS, apps, product teams	FREE/PAID	*Best-in-class for product analytics. Event-based, user-level tracking.*
Heap	Auto-capture product analytics	Product teams wanting retroactive analysis	FREE/PAID	*Captures everything by default. No pre-instrumentation needed.*
Amplitude	Product analytics, behavioral cohorts, journey analysis	Growth teams, product-led companies	FREE/PAID	*Competitor to Mixpanel. Strong behavioral analytics.*
Hotjar	Heatmaps, session recordings, user feedback	UX, CRO, landing page optimization	FREE/PAID	*Visual analytics. See where users click and drop off.*
Microsoft Clarity	Free heatmaps and session recordings	Any web property	FREE	*Hotjar alternative from Microsoft. Completely free. Good for small teams.*
Datadog	Infrastructure and application performance monitoring	DevOps, engineering teams	PAID	*Technical monitoring. Logs, metrics, traces. Not user-facing analytics.*
PostHog	Open-source product analytics + feature flags	Developer-led product teams, privacy-focused	FREE/PAID	*Self-hostable. Combines analytics, session replay, feature flags.*
Metabase	Open-source BI tool, SQL + no-code queries	Small data teams, startups	FREE/PAID	*Good entry-level BI. Connects to most databases.*

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Social Media & Advertising

Ad pixels, tracking, and social platforms. Understanding which pixels a client runs tells you a lot about their acquisition strategy. Every business running paid traffic has at least one of these installed.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Facebook / Meta Pixel	Conversion tracking and audience building for Meta ads	Any business running Facebook/Instagram ads	FREE	*Most installed pixel on the web. Required for Meta ad optimization.*
Google Ads / GTM	Search, display, YouTube ad tracking and tag management	Any business running Google ads	FREE	*Google Tag Manager manages all pixel deployments. Required for Google Ads.*
TikTok Pixel	Conversion tracking for TikTok ads	Consumer brands, younger demographics	FREE	*Growing fast. Required for TikTok ad optimization. Events API also available.*
Pinterest Tag	Conversion tracking for Pinterest ads	Visual products, home, fashion, DIY	FREE	*Niche but strong ROI for visual product categories.*
Snapchat Pixel	Conversion tracking for Snapchat ads	Under-35 consumer audiences	FREE	*Smaller reach but less saturated. Worth testing for the right audience.*
LinkedIn Insight Tag	Conversion tracking and audience building for LinkedIn ads	B2B, professional services, enterprise	FREE	*Required for LinkedIn ad optimization. Expensive CPCs but high intent B2B.*
Twitter/X Pixel	Conversion tracking for X/Twitter ads	Tech, media, commentary, cultural brands	FREE	*Declining ad effectiveness but still relevant for tech/media audiences.*
Loud Rumor	Gym/fitness marketing agency with proprietary tools	Fitness studios and gyms running paid ads	PAID	*Agency model. Seen in gym integration stacks. Focus on lead gen for fitness.*
Loyalsnap	Automated marketing for fitness studios	Fitness studios, boutique gyms	PAID	*Fitness-specific automated marketing. Works with Mindbody data.*
Referrizer	Referral automation and reputation management	Local service businesses	PAID	*Automates referral requests and Google review asks.*

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E-commerce & Storefronts

Where digital and physical products are sold. Platform choice determines checkout UX, affiliate capability, and integration complexity. Digital product sellers often use simpler tools than physical product sellers.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Shopify	E-commerce platform for physical and digital products	Physical product brands, D2C	PAID	*Dominant e-commerce platform. Massive app ecosystem. $39+/mo.*
Gumroad	Simple digital product storefront	Creators, solopreneurs, first digital product	FREE/PAID	*Zero monthly fee option. Takes % of sales. Best for simple digital products.*
Whop	Digital products, communities, software access	Discord communities, tools, info products	FREE/PAID	*Growing fast. Strong for community + digital product bundles.*
Stan Store	Link-in-bio storefront for creators	Social media creators, coaches	PAID	*$29/mo. Replaces Linktree + Gumroad. Popular on TikTok/Instagram.*
Lemon Squeezy	Digital products + software licensing + subscriptions	Software developers, SaaS builders	PAID	*Handles EU VAT automatically. Built for software/SaaS digital delivery.*
ThriveCart	Checkout, upsells, affiliates, LTV maximization	Digital product sellers, course creators	ONE-TIME	*One-time license. Strong upsell/bump mechanics. Affiliate management built in.*
WooCommerce	WordPress e-commerce plugin	WordPress sites, flexible/customized stores	FREE/PAID	*Free plugin, paid for hosting/extensions. Full control but requires maintenance.*
Etsy	Marketplace for handmade, vintage, digital downloads	Craft sellers, digital download creators	USAGE	*Built-in audience. Good for templates, printables, digital art.*
Payhip	Digital product and course sales	Creators wanting simple no-monthly-fee option	FREE/PAID	*Generous free tier. Handles EU VAT. Simple alternative to Gumroad.*

SECTION 09 / 19

Course & Community Platforms

Where knowledge products live. Platform choice affects course UX, community engagement, payment integration, and affiliate capability. Many creators run separate tools for course delivery and community.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Kajabi	All-in-one courses, communities, email, funnels, podcasting	Serious course creators, knowledge businesses	PAID	*$149+/mo. Premium positioning. Replaces many tools. Strong brand.*
Teachable	Course platform with payment and affiliate tools	Course creators, educators	FREE/PAID	*Popular mid-market option. Less feature-rich than Kajabi but lower cost.*
Thinkific	Course platform with community and commerce	Course creators, corporate training	FREE/PAID	*Kajabi/Teachable competitor. Good free tier. White-label option.*
Skool	Community + courses in a single interface	Community-led businesses, coaching programs	PAID	*$99/mo flat. Alex Hormozi-backed. Growing fast. Gamification built in.*
Circle	Community platform with events and courses	Premium communities, cohort-based courses	PAID	*Notion-like modern community UX. Strong for async + live hybrid.*
Podia	Courses, digital downloads, communities, email	Small creators wanting simple all-in-one	PAID	*Simpler than Kajabi. Good value at lower tier.*
Maven	Cohort-based course platform	Live/cohort courses, expert educators	USAGE	*Revenue share model. Built for live teaching formats.*
Mighty Networks	Community + courses + native app	Communities wanting a branded app	PAID	*Has native app builder. Strong community-first model.*

SECTION 10 / 19

Funnel & Landing Page Builders

Where prospects convert. Funnel builders determine the structure of the buying journey. Choice depends on technical comfort, budget, and integration needs.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
ClickFunnels 2.0	Funnel builder, courses, CRM, email, affiliate center	Info product sellers, coaching, digital products	PAID	*$147+/mo. Russell Brunson brand. Large community. Mature ecosystem.*
Systeme.io	All-in-one funnels, email, courses, affiliates	Budget-conscious marketers, beginners	FREE/PAID	*Free plan is strong. $27/mo for full suite. Strong value at entry level.*
GoHighLevel	Agency-grade funnels, CRM, automation, white-label	Marketing agencies, local service businesses	PAID	*$97–297/mo. White-label for resale. Most feature-dense option available.*
Leadpages	Landing pages and opt-in forms	Marketers needing fast standalone landing pages	PAID	*Solid drag-and-drop. Not a full funnel builder. Good for lead capture.*
Unbounce	Conversion-focused landing pages with AI assist	CRO-focused teams, agencies	PAID	*Smart Traffic feature auto-routes to best variant. Strong for paid traffic.*
Webflow	Visual web design + CMS + hosting	Designers, no-code builders, marketing sites	FREE/PAID	*Not a funnel builder but often used for landing pages. Full design control.*
Carrd	Simple one-page sites	Solo creators, link-in-bio, simple landing pages	FREE/PAID	*$9/yr Pro plan. Extremely lightweight. Good for fast single-page builds.*

SECTION 11 / 19

Accounting & Finance

Business financial operations. Most small-medium businesses use one of the top three. Freelancers and solo operators often start with Wave. Integration matters for automated invoice creation from CRM/e-commerce data.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
QuickBooks	Accounting, invoicing, payroll, tax prep	US-based SMBs, established businesses	PAID	*Most used small business accounting software in the US. $30+/mo.*
Xero	Cloud accounting, invoicing, bank reconciliation	SMBs, UK/ANZ preference, modern stack	PAID	*Strong QuickBooks competitor. Better API. Preferred by modern accountants.*
FreshBooks	Invoicing, time tracking, expenses for service businesses	Freelancers, service businesses	PAID	*Simpler than QB/Xero. Great for service-based billing.*
Wave	Free accounting, invoicing, receipt scanning	Freelancers, very small businesses	FREE/PAID	*Free accounting core. Charges for payroll and payment processing.*
Pilot	Outsourced bookkeeping + accounting service	Startups, funded companies	PAID	*Managed service, not software. Uses Xero/QBO as backend. VC-popular.*
Stripe Revenue Recognition	Automated revenue recognition for subscription businesses	SaaS with complex billing	PAID	*Add-on to Stripe. GAAP-compliant revenue reporting for subscriptions.*

SECTION 12 / 19

Staff, Operations & HR

Team management, scheduling, and HR tools. Fitness businesses commonly use workforce scheduling tools. Agencies and distributed teams lean toward async communication stacks.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Deputy	Shift scheduling, time tracking, workforce management	Shift-based businesses, gyms, retail, hospitality	PAID	*Common in gym/fitness vertical for staff scheduling.*
When I Work	Employee scheduling and time clocking	SMB shift-based teams	PAID	*Deputy competitor. Clean UX. Strong in retail and fitness.*
Gusto	Payroll, benefits, HR compliance	US SMBs with employees	PAID	*Most popular SMB payroll platform. Handles W-2s, benefits, onboarding.*
BambooHR	HR software — onboarding, performance, PTO, org chart	SMBs with growing people ops needs	PAID	*Mid-market HR platform. Strong onboarding and org management.*
Rippling	HR, IT, payroll unified platform	Tech-forward SMBs and mid-market	PAID	*Fastest-growing HR platform. Handles HR+IT in one. Strong automation.*
Slack	Team messaging and channel-based communication	Tech companies, remote teams, agencies	FREE/PAID	*Default team communication for most digital businesses.*
Notion	Docs, wikis, databases, project management	Knowledge workers, startups, product teams	FREE/PAID	*Internal knowledge base and project management hybrid.*
Asana	Project and task management	Marketing teams, agencies, project-heavy orgs	FREE/PAID	*Strong project tracking. Good for campaign and deliverable management.*
Linear	Issue tracking and project management for software teams	Engineering teams, product development	FREE/PAID	*Modern Jira alternative. Fast, clean, developer-preferred.*

SECTION 13 / 19

Automation & Integration Middleware

The glue between systems. Every business that uses more than 3–4 tools eventually needs middleware. Knowing this stack tells you how automated a client's operations already are.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Zapier	No-code workflow automation between apps	Non-technical teams, simple automation needs	FREE/PAID	*Most recognized. 6,000+ integrations. Expensive at high volume.*
Make (Integromat)	Visual workflow automation with complex logic	Power users, agencies, complex workflows	FREE/PAID	*More powerful and cheaper than Zapier. Visual canvas. Webhook native.*
n8n	Open-source workflow automation	Technical teams, privacy-focused, self-hosted	FREE/PAID	*Self-hostable. Growing fast. Best for developers.*
Pabbly Connect	Zapier alternative, one-time pricing available	Budget-conscious automators	ONE-TIME	*Lifetime license available. Good value for stable workflows.*
Pipedream	Developer-focused event-driven automation	Developers building complex integrations	FREE/PAID	*Code-first. Node.js/Python support. Strong for custom API work.*
Workato	Enterprise integration platform (iPaaS)	Enterprise IT, complex B2B integrations	PAID	*Enterprise-grade. Expensive. Replaces MuleSoft in some use cases.*
Tray.io	Enterprise automation and integration	Mid-enterprise, technical marketing ops	PAID	*More flexible than Workato for custom logic. Strong API connector.*

SECTION 14 / 19

Customer Support & Communication

How businesses talk to customers. Support stack choice affects response time, ticket organization, and knowledge base management. Live chat also drives conversion for high-ticket products.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Intercom	Live chat, help desk, AI support, product tours	SaaS, apps, digital product businesses	PAID	*Premium positioning. Strong for in-app messaging and onboarding flows.*
Zendesk	Enterprise ticketing, help desk, knowledge base	Mid-enterprise, high-volume support	PAID	*Industry standard for complex support operations. Expensive.*
Freshdesk	Help desk ticketing and live chat	SMBs wanting structured support	FREE/PAID	*Strong free tier. Good Zendesk alternative at lower cost.*
Crisp	Live chat, shared inbox, chatbot	Startups, small teams	FREE/PAID	*Good free tier. Multi-channel inbox. Strong WhatsApp integration.*
Tidio	Live chat + AI chatbot for e-commerce	E-commerce, Shopify stores	FREE/PAID	*Strong Shopify integration. AI chatbot on free tier.*
Gorgias	Helpdesk built for e-commerce, Shopify-native	Shopify brands, e-commerce	PAID	*Pulls order data into tickets automatically. E-commerce first.*
Front	Shared inbox for teams — email, chat, SMS, social	Customer-facing teams, agencies	PAID	*Turns email into a collaborative team inbox. Good for shared accounts.*

SECTION 15 / 19

SMS & Messaging

Direct mobile communication. SMS has 98% open rates. Businesses using SMS for marketing or support see significantly higher engagement than email alone.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Twilio	Programmable SMS, voice, email, WhatsApp API	Developers, custom communication workflows	USAGE	*Infrastructure layer. Used by most SMS apps as their backend.*
Attentive	SMS marketing platform for e-commerce	E-commerce, D2C brands	PAID	*Enterprise SMS marketing. Strong compliance tools. E-commerce focused.*
Klaviyo SMS	SMS + email in one platform	E-commerce brands already on Klaviyo	PAID	*Unified with email flows. Reduces vendor count for e-commerce stacks.*
SimpleTexting	SMS marketing campaigns and two-way messaging	Small-medium businesses	PAID	*Simple bulk SMS with keyword triggers. Good for local businesses.*
SlickText	SMS marketing and loyalty for small businesses	Restaurants, retail, local service businesses	PAID	*Loyalty/rewards SMS programs. Lower-cost option.*
EZTexting	SMS marketing for SMBs	Small businesses new to SMS marketing	PAID	*Easy onboarding. Templates library. Good starting point.*

SECTION 16 / 19

Access Control & Physical Security

Relevant for any business with a physical location — gyms, co-working spaces, studios. Modern access control systems integrate with membership software.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Kisi	Cloud-based door access control	Offices, co-working spaces, gyms	PAID	*Integrates with Google Workspace, Slack, Mindbody. API-first.*
Brivo	Cloud access control and video surveillance	Commercial buildings, gyms, multi-tenant	PAID	*Strong in gym vertical. Membership-triggered access.*
Salto	Smart lock and access management systems	Hotels, offices, residential	PAID	*Hardware + cloud. Strong in hospitality and commercial.*
Dormakaba	Physical access control hardware and software	Enterprise buildings, hospitality	PAID	*Established hardware vendor. Used in large facilities.*
OpenPath	Mobile-first access control	Modern offices, tech companies	PAID	*Tap-to-unlock via phone. Acquired by Motorola Solutions.*

SECTION 17 / 19

Video, Webinar & Live Events

Video infrastructure for marketing, sales calls, webinars, and live events. Every business running a sales process or online education needs at least one of these.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
Zoom	Video calls, webinars, virtual events	Universal — calls, demos, webinars	FREE/PAID	*Default video tool for most businesses. Webinar add-on available.*
Google Meet	Video calls integrated with Google Workspace	Google Workspace users	FREE/PAID	*Free with Google account. Simple but limited features vs Zoom.*
Loom	Async video messaging and screen recording	Remote teams, sales, documentation	FREE/PAID	*Strong for async communication. Screen + cam recording. Sales use case growing.*
StreamYard	Browser-based live streaming to multiple platforms	Livestreamers, podcasters, media companies	FREE/PAID	*Multi-destination streaming. Good for LinkedIn + YouTube + Facebook simultaneously.*
Vimeo	Professional video hosting and sharing	Marketing teams, agencies, creatives	FREE/PAID	*Ad-free video hosting. Password protection. Strong for client deliveries.*
Wistia	Video hosting with marketing analytics	B2B marketing, product demos, video SEO	FREE/PAID	*Viewer-level analytics. CTA overlays. Email gate on videos.*
Riverside.fm	High-quality podcast and video recording	Podcasters, interview-format content	FREE/PAID	*Records local tracks for each participant. Studio-quality remote recording.*
Demio	Webinar platform built for marketing	Marketers running automated or live webinars	PAID	*Cleaner UX than Zoom webinars. Good automation/replay features.*

SECTION 18 / 19

Website, CMS & Hosting

The digital home. Platform choice sets the ceiling on design flexibility, SEO performance, and long-term maintenance overhead.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
WordPress	Open-source CMS, complete content and e-commerce control	Content-heavy sites, SEO-focused, custom builds	FREE/PAID	*Powers ~43% of the web. Huge plugin ecosystem. WooCommerce for e-commerce.*
Webflow	Visual design-first CMS and hosting	Designers, agencies, marketing sites	FREE/PAID	*Best design control without code. Strong CMS. Growing fast.*
Squarespace	All-in-one website builder and hosting	Service businesses, portfolios, small brands	PAID	*Beautiful templates. Less flexible than Webflow. Owns Acuity.*
Wix	Drag-and-drop website builder	Small businesses, beginners	FREE/PAID	*Most flexible visual builder. SEO has improved significantly.*
Framer	Design-to-publish website platform	Startups, SaaS, modern marketing sites	FREE/PAID	*Growing fast. Strong design system support. AI features.*
Ghost	Publishing platform for newsletters and blogs	Writers, newsletter businesses, media	FREE/PAID	*Substack alternative with full ownership. Membership + email built in.*
Vercel	Frontend cloud deployment platform	Developers deploying Next.js/React apps	FREE/PAID	*Instant deploys. Edge functions. The default for modern web apps.*
Cloudflare Pages	Static site hosting with edge computing	Developers, JAMstack sites	FREE/PAID	*Free tier is excellent. Integrated with Cloudflare security and CDN.*

SECTION 19 / 19

AI & Emerging Tools

The fastest-moving category. AI tools are increasingly embedded into every other category. Knowing which AI tools a business uses signals their technical sophistication and workflow automation maturity.

TOOL / PLATFORM	WHAT IT DOES	BEST FOR	TIER	NOTES & CONTEXT
OpenAI / ChatGPT	LLM API + consumer AI assistant	Developers, knowledge workers, content creators	FREE/PAID	*Most recognized AI brand. GPT-4o is current flagship. Strong ecosystem.*
Anthropic / Claude	LLM API + consumer AI assistant	Developers, safety-focused use cases, long context	FREE/PAID	*Strong reasoning, long context, nuanced instruction following.*
Midjourney	AI image generation (Discord + web)	Designers, marketers, content creators	PAID	*Best-in-class image quality for creative work. No free tier.*
ElevenLabs	AI voice synthesis and cloning	Podcasters, video creators, accessibility	FREE/PAID	*Most realistic AI voice. Voice cloning from short sample.*
Runway	AI video generation and editing	Video creators, studios, marketers	FREE/PAID	*Leading AI video tool. Gen-3 model is state-of-the-art.*
Descript	AI-powered audio/video editing via transcript	Podcasters, video creators, marketers	FREE/PAID	*Edit video by editing text transcript. Overdub voice cloning.*
Perplexity	AI-powered search and research	Research, quick fact-finding, competitive intel	FREE/PAID	*Real-time web search + AI synthesis. Growing fast.*
Cursor	AI-first code editor	Developers building with AI assistance	FREE/PAID	*Fork of VS Code with deep AI integration. Dominant in AI-assisted dev.*
Make (AI)	Visual automation with AI model nodes	Automation builders, AI workflow development	FREE/PAID	*Native AI steps in workflows. LLM + image gen + function nodes.*
Magica	Node-based AI workflow platform	AI workflow developers, content automation	PAID	*Build, run, and automate AI pipelines. Workflows, direct model runs, webhooks. API-first. (Formerly Galaxy AI.)*

Update this reference as new tools are encountered or client stacks evolve.